### *US-Pakistan: Collective Security or Creating Insecurity? (1953–1954)*

The US would have liked to see India as part of its evolving collective security plans. Dulles was even willing to consider including nonaggression principles—of the Sino-Indian Panchsheel sort (discussed later in the chapter) that some were arguing for—if it would bring India and Burma into SEATO.[70] The Joint Chiefs of Staff, on their part, wanted to exclude India and focus on the Pacific.[71] But the State Department considered, with Eisenhower's approval, the idea of organizing a smaller group on military matters and another on economic development that could attract states like India.[72] Defense Secretary Charles Wilson thought Britain and India should take the initiative for any Southeast Asian consortium.[73] Wilson and National Security Adviser Robert Cutler favored an Asian economic grouping more than a US-sponsored military one, but Dulles thought the US had come too far to jettison the latter.[74] The US eventually dropped the idea of a dual-track group since neither Japan nor India were joining, and nonaligned countries were unlikely to participate in an economic grouping associated with the military treaty.[75]

Nehru's general belief that pacts "brought insecurity" meant he had no interest in SEATO.[76] He told parliament that the motivation for its creation —to ease the fears of countries in the region—might be good, but the approach was wrong.[77] It could only be seen as anti-China, he said at the Bogor conference that preceded the Bandung summit.[78] Nehru disagreed with the American view that China posed a clear and present danger in Southeast Asia. In another instance of mirror imaging, he told American ambassador George Allen that China did not have aggression on its mind; rather, like India, China wanted peace so that it could focus internally. Moreover, he disagreed with the Eisenhower administration's military approach, arguing that it increased rather than alleviated insecurity. He stated that the US should accept Chinese assurances that they would not indulge in aggression and, in turn, assure Beijing that it would not try to invade China or overthrow the communist regime. In what had become a familiar retort, however, Allen argued that, given its apparent expansionist tendencies in Korea and Indochina, China needed to reassure the US first.[79]